UPSC CIVIL SERVICES · DAILY CURRENT AFFAIRS

UPSC Intel · Daily Brief

TUESDAY, 27 OCTOBER 2026

16 must-know stories, 26 Prelims facts, 15 editorials and 12 explainers, picked from 1,035 stories reported. Each item links to its source; notes quote the reports.

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MUST-KNOW

High-yield stories: make notes on these. Grouped by syllabus area.

Polity & Constitution

GS2 MAKE NOTES

Data protection law challenge: SC stresses balancing privacy rights with press freedom

The Digital News Publishers Association has moved the Supreme Court of India against the digital data protection law, stating it threatens press freedom and investigative journalism. Twenty one news publishers, including major media companies, approached the court through the DNPA on October 6 to challenge parts of the Digital Personal Data Protection Act, 2023, and its 2025 rules. The core issue centers on the absence of a specific exemption for journalistic work, which publishers argue could hinder investigations and the protection of confidential sources. The petition highlights that reporters might be forced to seek permission from individuals under scrutiny before processing data, potentially allowing targets to destroy evidence. The DNPA challenges provisions allowing individuals to withdraw consent and demand erasure of personal data, which could lead to demands to remove factual news reports. The association also challenges Section 36 of the Act and Rule 23, arguing that government powers to seek information lack clear limits, judicial oversight, and proportionality. The petition contests an amendment to the Right to Information Act, 2005, introduced via Section 44(3) of the data protection law, which places personal information beyond disclosure.

When: 2026-10-27 · **Where:** India · **Who:** Digital News Publishers Association and the Supreme Court of India · **Prelims:** The petition was filed by the Digital News Publishers Association on October 6.; Twenty one news publishers joined the petition through the DNPA.; Disputed provisions of the digital personal data protection law are scheduled to take effect in May 2027.

> ***Why it matters —*** *It addresses the complex legal balance between individual right to privacy and the public's right to information and free press.; It tests the constitutional validity of provisions within the Digital Personal Data Protection Act, 2023, and its interface with the Right to Information Act, 2005.*

Static — The Digital Personal Data Protection (DPDP) Act, 2023, governs the processing of digital personal data within India, aiming to recognize both individuals' right to protect personal data and the need to process it for lawful purposes. Freedom of speech and expression, which encompasses press freedom, is guaranteed under Article 19(1)(a) of the Indian Constitution, subject to reasonable restrictions under Article 19(2). The Right to Information (RTI) Act, 2005, empowers citizens to secure access to information under the control of public authorities, promoting transparency and accountability.

Syllabus: GS2: Polity & Constitution, Science & Technology · Prelims angle: Report/Index, Judgment

Hindustan Times: read the source · free copy on thenewsminute.com · also reported by Inc42, NEXT IAS, Business Standard, CNBC TV18, LawChakra, The New Indian Express, Deccan Herald, Rediff, Times of India

GS2 MAKE NOTES

Section 18 of 2023 CEC Act in focus as poll panel defends decision-making before Supreme Court

The Election Commission of India filed a counter affidavit in the Supreme Court relying on Section 18 of the 2023 CEC Act. The commission defended three orders on special intensive revision issued on June 24, 2025, October 27, 2025, and May 14, 2026, claiming they were unanimous. Opposition petitioners led by Rahul Gandhi argue that collective powers were exercised unilaterally by Chief Election Commissioner Gyanesh Kumar. Section 18 sub-section (1) allows the commission to regulate business procedure and allocate business by unanimous decision. Sub-section (2) states business must be transacted unanimously as far as possible, with differences settled by majority opinion. Petitioners point out that Section 16 of the 2023 Act grants civil and criminal immunity to members for acts done during duty. The ECI affidavit states that individual queries or objections during deliberations do not constitute formal decisions under Section 18. The Supreme Court hearing will determine if Section 18 requires a recorded process for decisions or merely settles disagreements.

When: 2026-10-27 · **Where:** New Delhi · **Who:** Election Commission of India, Gyanesh Kumar, Sukhbir Singh Sandhu, Vivek Joshi, Rahul Gandhi, Bhanu Prakash Yeturu · **Prelims:** Section 18 of the 2023 CEC Act deals with the transaction of business by the Election Commission.; Special intensive revision orders were issued by the ECI on June 24, 2025, October 27, 2025, and May 14, 2026.; Section 16 of the 2023 Act provides immunity from civil and criminal proceedings to present and former election commissioners.

> ***Why it matters —*** *Clarifies the statutory interpretation of collective decision-making within independent constitutional bodies like the ECI.; Examines the balance of power between the Chief Election Commissioner and other election commissioners under the 2023 Act.*

Static — Article 324 of the Constitution provides for the establishment of the Election Commission of India to superintend, direct and control elections. The Chief Election Commissioner and Other Election Commissioners (Appointment, Conditions of Service and Term of Office) Act, 2023 regulates their service terms and appointment. The Election Commission is a multi-member body consisting of the Chief Election Commissioner and other election commissioners as fixed by the President.

Syllabus: GS2: Polity & Constitution · Prelims angle: Judgment, Act/Bill/Rules

Hindustan Times: read the source · also reported by The Hindu

GS2 MAKE NOTES

UAPA does not bar bail for all foreigners; illegal entry is key, rules SC

The Supreme Court held that the statutory bail bar under Section 43D(7) of the UAPA applies to foreigners only if their initial entry into India was illegal. The bench of Justices Aravind Kumar and Vipul M Pancholi clarified that lawful entry on a valid visa whose stay later becomes unauthorised does not attract this restriction. The court dismissed the Union government's appeal against a Madras High Court order that had restored bail to accused Mohamed Rifas. Rifas, a Sri Lankan national, was accused in a 2018 FIR involving offences under the IPC, UAPA, and Arms Act, and was initially granted statutory default bail in July 2018. The NIA took over the case in 2019 and registered a separate FIR alleging Rifas entered India in 2009, overstayed his visa, and illegally obtained Indian identity documents. A special court cancelled his bail in 2022, but the Madras High Court restored it in December 2023, noting the delay and lack of proof for initial illegal entry. The Supreme Court affirmed the High Court order, noting the Centre failed to produce material prima facie establishing initial unauthorised entry into India.

When: 2026-10-27 · **Where:** New Delhi · **Who:** Supreme Court bench of Justices Aravind Kumar and Vipul M Pancholi · **Prelims:** Section 43D(7) of the UAPA places restrictions on the grant of bail to foreign nationals.; Mohamed Rifas was accused in an FIR registered on April 2, 2018, at Keelakarai police station in Tamil Nadu.; The NIA took over the case and registered a separate FIR in 2019 alleging the accused was a Sri Lankan national who entered India in 2009.

> ***Why it matters —*** *Clarifies the precise legal threshold required to invoke the stringent bail bar against foreign nationals under the UAPA.; Protects statutory default bail rights under Section 167(2) of the CrPC from being overridden by subsequent allegations unless initial entry conditions are met.*

Static — The Unlawful Activities (Prevention) Act (UAPA) is India's primary anti-terror law enacted in 1967 to prevent unlawful activities associations. Section 43D of the UAPA introduces special provisions for bail, making it harder for accused persons to secure release if the court is of the opinion that the accusation is prima facie true. Statutory default bail or compulsory bail is governed under Section 167(2) of the Code of Criminal Procedure (CrPC), granted when the investigating agency fails to file a chargesheet within the stipulated timeframe.

Syllabus: GS2: Polity & Constitution, Internal Security · Prelims angle: Judgment

Hindustan Times: read the source · free copy on deccanherald.com · also reported by Court Book, RBI, LiveLaw

International Relations

GS2 MAKE NOTES

New UNSC permanent members without veto would be 'second-class': India

India called for comprehensive reforms of the United Nations Security Council, stating that all permanent members must have equal rights, responsibilities, and the veto power. India delivered this statement through its permanent representative Parvathaneni Harish at the United Nations. India strongly opposed creating a separate category of permanent members without the veto or with fewer powers, warning it would deepen existing inequalities. India emphasized that its position on the veto is aligned with the Common African Position and demands fairness and justice for all permanent members. Harish stated that creating a new category of permanent members with or without veto would further complicate discussions and entrench inequity. The UN history shows that the veto has been exercised 331 times on around 200 resolutions, with most vetos or threats coming from three of the P5 nations. India questioned the effectiveness of the 2022 UN General Assembly accountability measure requiring debates after a veto, noting it brought no expected change. India highlighted the de facto veto in working methods, where the consensus rule allows a single member to block presidential statements and sanctions committee decisions.

When: 2026-10-27 · **Where:** New York, United Nations · **Who:** Parvathaneni Harish · **Prelims:** The veto has been exercised 331 times on around 200 resolutions over the UN's history.; Accountability measures requiring UN General Assembly debates on veto usage were adopted in the year 2022.; Parvathaneni Harish serves as India's permanent representative to the United Nations.

> ***Why it matters —*** *Reflects India's consistent diplomatic push for equitable representation in top global multilateral bodies.; Highlights structural flaws in the UN decision-making process, including the misuse of formal and de facto veto powers.*

Static — The United Nations Security Council is one of the six principal organs of the UN, tasked with maintaining international peace and security. The UNSC consists of 15 members: five permanent members (China, France, Russia, the United Kingdom, and the United States) and ten non-permanent members elected for two-year terms. Under Article 27 of the UN Charter, decisions on procedural matters require nine votes, while substantive matters require nine votes including the concurrent votes of the permanent members, creating the veto power.

Syllabus: GS2: International Relations

Times of India: read the source · also reported by Daijiworld, PSU India, Hindustan Times, Firstpost, Outlook India, Moneycontrol.com, Deccan Chronicle, DD News

Economy

GS2 GS3 MAKE NOTES

Cabinet approves Rs 33,660 crore BHAVYA scheme to develop 100 industrial parks

The Union Cabinet approved the Bharat Audyogik Vikas Yojna (BHAVYA) with a total financial outlay of Rs. 33,660 crore. The scheme aims to develop 100 plug-and-play industrial parks across the country to boost manufacturing and investments. It forms a key pillar of India's vision for Viksit Bharat and Atmanirbhar Bharat by generating large-scale employment. BHAVYA will build on the success of industrial smart cities under the National Industrial Corridor Development Programme. The initiative will be implemented in partnership with states and private players, with parks sized between 100 and 1,000 acres. Financial assistance of up to Rs. 1 crore per acre is provided for core, value-added, and social infrastructure. Additional support of up to 25 percent of the project cost will be extended for external connectivity infrastructure. Project selection uses a challenge-based mechanism, ensuring that only high-quality and investment-ready proposals are approved. The industrial parks will feature single-window clearances, green energy solutions, and alignment with PM GatiShakti principles.

When: 2026-10-27 · **Where:** India · **Who:** Union Cabinet, Prime Minister Narendra Modi, National Industrial Corridor Development Corporation · **Prelims:** Total financial outlay for the BHAVYA scheme is Rs. 33,660 crore.; The scheme aims to develop 100 plug-and-play industrial parks.; Industrial parks will range in size from 100 to 1,000 acres.

> ***Why it matters —*** *Significantly reduces entry barriers for investors and improves the ease of doing business through pre-approved land and single-window clearances.; Strengthens domestic supply chains and supports regional industrialisation by promoting cluster-based development.*

Static — Plug-and-play industrial infrastructure refers to readymade factory spaces equipped with all necessary utilities, roads, and clearances, minimizing setup time for businesses. The National Industrial Corridor Development Programme (NICDP) is India's flagship initiative to develop futuristic industrial cities as growth nodes. PM GatiShakti is a national master plan for multimodal connectivity, aiming to bring infrastructure projects together and reduce logistics costs.

Syllabus: GS2 / GS3: Economy, Governance & Policy · Prelims angle: Scheme, Data/Stats

ddnews.gov.in: read the source

GS3 MAKE NOTES

Premature redemption under Sovereign Gold Bond (SGB) Scheme - Redemption Price for premature redemption of SGB 2020-21 Series I due on October 28, 2026

The Reserve Bank of India announced the operational details and pricing mechanism for the premature redemption of Sovereign Gold Bond 2020-21 Series I due on October 28, 2026. In terms of GOI notification F.No. 4(5)-B(W&M)/2021 dated October 21, 2021 (SGB 2021-22 Series VII - Issue date November 02, 2021) on Sovereign Gold Bond Scheme, premature redemption of Gold Bond may be permitted after fifth year from the date of issue of such Gold Bond on the date on which interest is payable. Accordingly, the due date of premature redemption of the above tranche shall be on November 02, 2026. Further, the redemption price of SGB shall be based on simple average of closing price of gold of 999 purity of previous three business days from the date of redemption, as published by the India Bullion and Jewellers Association Ltd (IBJA).

When: October 28, 2026 · **Where:** India · **Who:** Reserve Bank of India and India Bullion and Jewellers Association Ltd · **Prelims:** The issue date of SGB 2020-21 Series I was April 28, 2020.; The premature redemption due date for this tranche is October 28, 2026.; Redemption prices are based on the simple average of the closing price of gold of 999 purity of the previous three business days.

> ***Why it matters —*** *Provides a secure and transparent exit mechanism for long-term gold bond investors before the final maturity date.; Demonstrates the structured implementation of government borrowing and sovereign gold bond schemes through the RBI.*

Static — The Sovereign Gold Bond Scheme was launched by the Government of India in 2015 under the Gold Monetisation Scheme. The Reserve Bank of India issues the bonds on behalf of the Government of India. Bonds are denominated in multiples of gram(s) of gold with a basic unit of 1 gram.

Syllabus: GS3: Economy, Governance & Policy · Prelims angle: Scheme, Act/Bill/Rules

RBI: read the source

GS3 MAKE NOTES

Parliament passes Mines and Minerals Amendment Bill, 2026

Parliament passed the Mines and Minerals (Development and Regulation) Amendment Bill, 2026, restricting state powers to levy taxes on mineral rights and lands. The Lok Sabha cleared the legislation on Wednesday and the Rajya Sabha passed it on Thursday, awaiting presidential assent to become law. Union Mines Minister G Kishan Reddy stated the Bill aims to ensure uniform mineral rates nationwide without interfering with states' revenue autonomy. The Centre will regulate major minerals like coal, limestone, iron ore, copper, and manganese, while states retain powers over 49 minor minerals. Coal remains crucial for India, accounting for 73 percent of electricity generation and requiring reliable supply to keep industry competitive. The Minister noted that the share of mineral revenue to states increased from 65 percent in 2014-15 to 85 percent currently, ensuring no losses. The legislation invokes Entry 54 of the Union List, empowering Parliament to regulate mines and mineral development in the public interest. The Bill was passed amidst opposition protests, sloganeering, and the rejection of a motion by DMK MP Tiruchi Siva to send it to a Select Committee.

When: 2026-10-27 · **Where:** New Delhi · **Who:** Union Mines Minister G Kishan Reddy · **Prelims:** The Lok Sabha passed the Bill on Wednesday and the Rajya Sabha cleared it on Thursday.; Coal accounts for 73 percent of electricity generation in India.; States currently receive around 85 percent of mineral revenue and 96 percent of coal revenue.

> ***Why it matters —*** *Ensures uniform mineral rates across India to maintain industrial competitiveness.; Clarifies regulatory jurisdiction between the Centre and states over major and minor minerals.*

Static — The Mines and Minerals (Development and Regulation) Act (MMDR Act) regulates the mining sector in India and specifies the requirement and procedure for obtaining mining leases. Entry 54 of the Union List (List I) in the Seventh Schedule of the Constitution empowers Parliament to legislate on regulation of mines and mineral development to the extent specified in public interest. Entry 23 of the State List (List II) subjects the regulation of mines and mineral development to the provisions of the Union List enacted by Parliament.

Syllabus: GS3: Economy, Polity & Constitution, Geography · Prelims angle: Act/Bill/Rules

ddnews.gov.in: read the source · also reported by DD News

GS3 MAKE NOTES

Cabinet approves Rs 52,878 crore sale of 60.72% stake in IDBI Bank to Fairfax entity

The Cabinet Committee on Economic Affairs approved Canada-based Fairfax Financial Holdings Ltd. as the strategic buyer for a 60.72% stake in IDBI Bank for about Rs 52,878.08 crore. The transaction includes the sale of a 30.48% stake held by the Government of India and a 30.24% stake held by Life Insurance Corporation of India. The winning offer of Rs 81 per share surpassed the benchmark valuation of Rs 75.99 per share and individual fair-value estimates from independent agencies. The successful bidder must present credentials to the Reserve Bank of India for fit-and-proper assessment and submit a regulatory compliance roadmap. Once completed, this transaction will mark the largest foreign direct investment in India’s financial sector to date. The sale followed a two-stage competitive bidding process overseen by an Inter-Ministerial Group, Core Group of Secretaries on Disinvestment, and an Alternative Mechanism. Initial bids invited in FY 2025-26 fell short of the reserve price, leading to subsequent sealed bids invited in FY 2026-27. Independent valuation agencies used market-multiple relative valuation and asset valuation methods based on March 31, 2026 closing accounts to set the benchmark.

When: 2026-10-27 · **Where:** India · **Who:** Cabinet Committee on Economic Affairs, Fairfax Financial Holdings Ltd., Government of India, Life Insurance Corporation of India, Reserve Bank of India · **Prelims:** The winning offer for the IDBI Bank stake was Rs 81 per share.; The transaction comprises a 30.48% government stake and a 30.24% LIC stake.; The benchmark valuation determined by independent agencies was Rs 75.99 per share.

> ***Why it matters —*** *It marks the largest foreign direct investment in India's financial sector to date.; It represents a major milestone in the government's strategic disinvestment and privatization program.*

Static — IDBI Bank was established in 1964 under the Industrial Development Bank of India Act as a financial institution to provide credit for industrial development. In 2004, IDBI was converted into a banking company, and it was categorized as a private sector bank by the RBI in January 2019 after LIC acquired a controlling stake. The Cabinet Committee on Economic Affairs handles central government policies on economic growth, investment, and strategic disinvestment of public sector undertakings.

Syllabus: GS3: Economy, Governance & Policy · Prelims angle: Data/Stats

ddnews.gov.in: read the source

GS3 MAKE NOTES

RBI steps up liquidity support as tighter cash conditions push up borrowing rates: Report

Tightening liquidity in the banking system has pushed up short-term borrowing rates and prompted the Reserve Bank of India to inject funds into banks. The banking system surplus liquidity fell sharply due to GST payments, higher cash reserve requirements, and other factors, standing at Rs 50,000 crore as of October 23. The RBI conducted variable-rate repo auctions to provide short-term funds to banks, including a seven-day operation worth Rs 1 lakh crore. The weekly average call rate rose to 5.70 per cent, the average market repo rate rose to 5.66 per cent, and the triparty repo rate increased to 5.65 per cent. Government bond yields came under pressure as rising oil prices raised concerns about inflation and the possibility of higher interest rates. The average cost of government borrowing at the auction rose by 20 basis points to 7.60 per cent, with a bid-to-cover ratio of 1.9. Government spending towards month-end and maturity of government securities worth Rs 35,400 crore could release funds and ease pressure on short-term rates.

When: 2026-10-27 · **Where:** India · **Who:** Reserve Bank of India, ICICI Bank · **Prelims:** Banking system surplus liquidity stood at Rs 50,000 crore as of October 23.; The weekly average call rate rose to 5.70 per cent.; The average cost of government borrowing at the auction rose to 7.60 per cent.

> ***Why it matters —*** *Highlights the operational challenges in managing short-term banking liquidity and credit availability in India.; Demonstrates how external shocks like rising global oil prices directly impact domestic government bond yields and borrowing costs.*

Static — The Reserve Bank of India is India's central banking institution, established on April 1, 1935, under the Reserve Bank of India Act, 1934. Variable-rate repo operations are liquidity management tools used by the central bank to inject short-term funds into the banking system at market-determined rates. Net demand and time liabilities represent the total deposits of banks on which reserves like Cash Reserve Ratio and Statutory Liquidity Ratio are calculated.

Syllabus: GS3: Economy · Prelims angle: Report/Index

Economic Times: read the source · free copy on msn.com

GS3 MAKE NOTES

USD 10 billion catalytic capital could help unlock USD 500 billion for India's climate goals by 2030: CEEW-Tata Sons report

A new report by CEEW and Tata Sons states that USD 10 billion in catalytic capital could unlock USD 500 billion for India's climate goals by 2030. The financial push aims to support 20 low-carbon technologies across key sectors including power, renewables, green hydrogen, and electric mobility. The report titled 'Blended Finance for India's Climate Goals' notes that every dollar of catalytic capital can mobilize five dollars in blended finance. Sectoral allocations include USD 198 billion for power and renewables, USD 115 billion for green hydrogen, and USD 187 billion for electric mobility. Tata Sons Chairman N Chandrasekaran emphasized that conventional finance alone is insufficient for India's dual challenge of decarbonization and industrialization. The report explains that mature technologies like solar energy require less catalytic capital compared to nascent sectors like green hydrogen which need more risk-sharing support. To boost climate financing, the report recommends establishing a National Green Finance Institution, as proposed by NITI Aayog, to pool catalytic capital from multiple sources.

When: 2026-10-27 · **Where:** India · **Who:** Council on Energy, Environment and Water (CEEW), Tata Sons, N Chandrasekaran, NITI Aayog · **Prelims:** USD 10 billion in catalytic capital could generate USD 50 billion in blended finance.; The target investment of USD 500 billion is aimed across 20 low-carbon technologies by 2030.; Allocations include USD 198 billion for power and renewables, USD 115 billion for green hydrogen, and USD 187 billion for electric mobility.

> ***Why it matters —*** *Provides a strategic financial roadmap for India to bridge the massive green investment gap required to meet its 2030 climate targets.; Outlines specific sectoral capital allocations for critical emerging areas like green hydrogen and electric mobility.*

Static — Catalytic capital is risk-tolerant, patient, and concessionary funding that accepts disproportionate risks and lower-than-market financial returns to generate positive climate or social impacts. Blended finance strategically uses development finance and philanthropic funds to mobilize private capital flows towards emerging markets and sustainable development projects. India has committed to achieving net-zero emissions by 2070 and aims to meet 50 percent of its electric power requirements from non-fossil fuel sources by 2030.

Syllabus: GS3: Economy, Environment & Ecology · Prelims angle: Report/Index

lokmattimes.com: read the source

GS3 MAKE NOTES

RBI Governor Sanjay Malhotra urges states to ensure quality spending, prudent borrowing

RBI Governor Sanjay Malhotra advised State governments to adopt prudent borrowing strategies, maintain quality expenditure, and manage cash efficiently. The advice was delivered at the 36th Conference of State Finance Secretaries held in Mumbai on 27 October 2026. The conference theme focused on the role of quality expenditure, effective cash, and prudent debt management in enhancing states' fiscal sustainability. Malhotra released the Compendium on Cash and Debt Management for State Governments during the event. He urged states to utilize the State Level Bankers Committee forum effectively and onboard onto the Unified Lending Interface. States were also encouraged to use Programmable Central Bank Digital Currency for Direct Benefit Transfers. The conference reviewed market borrowings by states, short-term financial accommodation from the RBI, and the Benchmark Issuance Strategy. Finance secretaries from 27 States and 3 UTs attended, alongside officials from the Union Ministry of Finance, CGA, and CAG.

When: 27 October 2026 · **Where:** Mumbai · **Who:** Sanjay Malhotra (RBI Governor) · **Prelims:** The 36th Conference of State Finance Secretaries was held in Mumbai on 27 October 2026.; Article 293 of the Constitution concerns borrowing by States.; The Reserve Bank of India began operations on 1 April 1935.

> ***Why it matters —*** *Promotes fiscal prudence and long-term sustainability of state government finances.; Encourages integration of digital public infrastructure such as ULI and Programmable CBDC in governance.*

Static — Article 293 of the Constitution of India governs borrowing by States, with clause 3 requiring Union consent under certain conditions. The Reserve Bank of India was established under the Reserve Bank of India Act, 1934, and began operations on 1 April 1935. The RBI was subsequently nationalised on 1 January 1949 and functions as India's central bank with headquarters in Mumbai.

Syllabus: GS3: Economy, Polity & Constitution, Governance & Policy

Economic Times: read the source · *free copy on gktoday.in*

GS3 MAKE NOTES

Centre eases GST rules for post-sales discounts, no prior agreement needed from November 1

The Central government announced the rule change to simplify compliance and ease tax burdens for businesses effective November 1. The Centre has relaxed GST regulations for post-sales discounts, eliminating the mandatory requirement of a prior agreement starting November 1. The Centre eases GST rules on post-sales discounts from November 1, no longer requiring a prior agreement, which is expected to help FMCG and pharma companies and retailers.

When: November 1 · **Where:** India · **Who:** The Centre · **Prelims:** The new rules for post-sales discounts take effect from November 1.; FMCG, pharma companies, and retailers are expected to benefit from the change.; No prior agreement will be needed for post-sales discounts under the revised rules.

> ***Why it matters —*** *Reduces compliance burden and litigation for businesses handling volume and promotional discounts.; Provides significant financial and operational relief to FMCG, pharmaceutical, and retail sectors.*

Static — Goods and Services Tax (GST) is a comprehensive indirect tax levied on the manufacture, sale, and consumption of goods and services across India. GST was introduced on July 1, 2017, through the 101st Constitutional Amendment Act, subsuming multiple central and state taxes. The GST Council, chaired by the Union Finance Minister and comprising state finance ministers, is the apex body for making key GST policy decisions.

Syllabus: GS3: Economy · Prelims angle: Agreement/MoU

Economic Times: read the source

Environment & Ecology

GS3 MAKE NOTES

Current climate pledges will cut emissions by just 6% by 2035, far off track: UN report

A UN report released on Tuesday stated that current climate pledges will cut global greenhouse gas emissions by only 6 percent below 2019 levels by 2035. Even with conditional elements fully implemented, emissions are projected to drop by just 9 percent below 2019 levels by 2035. This projected reduction is substantially off track compared to the dip required to limit global warming effectively. The 2026 Nationally Determined Contributions Synthesis Report was published by the United Nations Framework Convention on Climate Change. Findings are based on 127 new NDCs representing 154 parties to the 2015 Paris Agreement, submitted between January 1, 2024, and August 31, 2026. Most new NDCs target net-zero emissions between 2040 and 2070, with the majority aiming for 2050. Implementation of these targets implies a best-estimate warming of 1.7 to 2.3 degrees Celsius by the end of the century. Returning warming to 1.5 degrees Celsius requires substantial additional greenhouse gas emission reductions in coming years.

When: 2026-10-27 · **Where:** New Delhi · **Who:** United Nations Framework Convention on Climate Change · **Prelims:** Report name: 2026 Nationally Determined Contributions Synthesis Report; Publishing body: United Nations Framework Convention on Climate Change; Number of new NDCs examined: 127 new NDCs representing 154 parties

> ***Why it matters —*** *Highlights the inadequacy of current global climate commitments in restricting temperature rises.; Underscores the widening gap between stated national goals and required scientific trajectories.*

Static — The United Nations Framework Convention on Climate Change is an international environmental treaty adopted in 1992 to stabilize greenhouse gas concentrations. Nationally Determined Contributions are national climate plans under the 2015 Paris Agreement highlighting actions to cut emissions and adapt to climate impacts. The Paris Agreement requires each party to prepare, communicate and maintain successive NDCs that it intends to achieve, representing a progression over time.

Syllabus: GS3: Environment & Ecology, International Relations · Prelims angle: Report/Index

The Hindu: read the source · *free copy on theprint.in*

GS3 MAKE NOTES

Carbon Capture, Utilisation and Storage

Thailand is developing rules and governance for carbon capture, utilisation and storage (CCUS) projects to curb emissions and shift to a low-carbon economy. A newly formed panel chaired by Energy Minister Akanat Prompan held its first meeting to drive greenhouse gas reduction through applied CCUS technology. Unlike CCS which focuses solely on permanent underground storage, CCUS includes reusing or recycling CO2 in commercial or industrial products. The panel is tasked with studying, analysing and drafting CCUS legal frameworks, economic incentives, and a dedicated CCUS bill. Legal challenges include navigating different laws governing factories, upstream petroleum activities, and subsurface storage. Thailand aims to achieve net-zero greenhouse gas emissions by 2050 and cut emissions by 47% by 2037. The National Science and Technology Development Agency published Thailand's first CCUS Technology Roadmap in 2023 targeting 20 million tonnes of annual storage by 2050. The panel endorsed support measures for the Arthit gas field's CCS pilot project, operated by PTT Exploration and Production Plc, to capture up to 1 million tonnes of CO2 annually.

When: 2026-10-27 · **Where:** Thailand · **Who:** Energy Minister Akanat Prompan, PTT Exploration and Production Plc · **Prelims:** Thailand aims to achieve net-zero greenhouse gas emissions by 2050 and cut emissions by 47% by 2037.; The National Science and Technology Development Agency published Thailand's first CCUS Technology Roadmap in 2023.; The Arthit gas field's CCS pilot project is operated by PTT Exploration and Production Plc.

> ***Why it matters —*** *Highlights how developing nations are creating dedicated legal and tax frameworks to scale up unproven industrial carbon management technologies.; Demonstrates the integration of carbon capture as a pillar in national power development plans and net-zero emission timelines.*

Static — Carbon Capture, Utilisation and Storage (CCUS) involves capturing carbon dioxide emissions from fuel combustion or industrial processes, preventing their release into the atmosphere. Captured carbon can be recycled for industrial use such as in enhanced oil recovery, synthetic fuels, and building materials, or permanently stored in deep underground geological formations. CCUS is considered vital for decarbonising hard-to-abate sectors like steel, cement, chemicals, and power generation where direct electrification is difficult.

Syllabus: GS3: Environment & Ecology, Infrastructure & Energy

PIB: read the source · *free copy on msn.com*

GS3 MAKE NOTES

India Reaffirms Commitment to Biodiversity Conservation and Effective Implementation of Global Biodiversity Framework at CBD COP-17 at Yerevan, Armenia

The event took place at the 17th Conference of the Parties to the Convention on Biological Diversity (CBD COP-17) hosted by Armenia. Union Minister Shri Bhupender Yadav delivered India's National Statement at CBD COP-17 in Yerevan, Armenia, highlighting India's targets, conservation networks, and demands for predictable climate finance. The Minister reaffirmed India’s commitment to conserving biodiversity and strengthening collective efforts to live in harmony with nature. He appreciated the Government of Armenia for hosting the seventeenth meeting of the CBD. Shri Yadav emphasized that implementation of the Kunming–Montreal Global Biodiversity Framework must be aligned with national priorities, circumstances and legislation, and supported by adequate and predictab

When: 2026-10-27 · **Where:** Yerevan, Armenia · **Who:** Shri Bhupender Yadav, Union Minister for Environment, Forest and Climate Change · **Prelims:** India has 1,134 Protected Areas, 103 Ramsar sites, 57 Biodiversity Heritage Sites, and 18 Biosphere Reserves.; 13 Biosphere Reserves in India are under UNESCO's Man and the Biosphere Network.; India's updated National Biodiversity Strategy and Action Plan contains 23 National Biodiversity Targets and 142 indicators.

> ***Why it matters —*** *Highlights India's diplomatic stance on ensuring developed countries provide adequate finance and technology transfer for global biodiversity goals.; Showcases India's domestic biodiversity achievements, including Ramsar sites, protected areas, and community-driven initiatives like Mission LiFE.*

Static — The Convention on Biological Diversity (CBD) is a legally binding multilateral treaty for the conservation of biodiversity, sustainable use of its components, and fair sharing of benefits arising from genetic resources. The CBD was opened for signature at the Earth Summit in Rio de Janeiro in 1992 and entered into force in 1993. The Conference of the Parties (COP) is the governing body of the Convention, advancing its implementation through regular decisions.

Syllabus: GS3: Environment & Ecology, Governance & Policy, International Relations

PIB: read the source · also reported by The New Indian Express, Social News XYZ

Defence

GS3 MAKE NOTES

Defence Ministry clears Rs. 2.12 lakh crore military acquisitions, including 200 helicopters

The defence ministry approved military acquisitions and weapon procurements amounting to Rs 2.12 lakh crore. The procurement proposals were cleared by the Defence Acquisition Council chaired by Defence Minister Rajnath Singh. The acquisitions include 323 K9 Vajra artillery guns and 200 Light Multi-Role Helicopters for the armed forces. Approvals for the Indian Army include high mobility vehicles, self-propelled tracked gun systems, and long-range Kamikaze drone systems. The Indian Navy received approval for an active offboard decoy system and other major naval platforms. The Indian Air Force will receive 24 Special Utility Helicopters for VVIP transport and new radar systems. Approximately 82 percent of the total Acceptances of Necessity accorded will be procured from the domestic Indian industry.

When: 2026-10-27 · **Where:** New Delhi · **Who:** Defence Acquisition Council, Defence Minister Rajnath Singh, Indian Army, Indian Navy, Indian Air Force · **Prelims:** Total cost of approved military acquisitions is Rs 2.12 lakh crore.; The Defence Acquisition Council is chaired by Defence Minister Rajnath Singh.; Proposals include 323 K9 Vajra artillery guns and 200 Light Multi-Role Helicopters.

> ***Why it matters —*** *Significantly boosts the operational readiness and modernization of the Indian Army, Navy, and Air Force.; Promotes domestic manufacturing with 82 percent of procurements sourced from Indian industry.*

Static — The Defence Acquisition Council is the apex decision-making body in the Ministry of Defence for deciding on new policies and capital acquisitions. The DAC is headed by the Defence Minister of India to ensure timely procurement of military equipment for the armed forces. Acceptance of Necessity marks the formal beginning of the procurement process and indicates the defence ministry's agreement to the requirement.

Syllabus: GS3: Defence, Governance & Policy · Prelims angle: Data/Stats

Economic Times: read the source · free copy on ptinews.com · also reported by India News Network

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PRELIMS FACTS

Concrete developments worth a quick read: exercises, pacts, Acts, approvals, schemes, species, verdicts.

POLITY & CONSTITUTION REPORT/INDEX ACT/BILL/RULES QUICK READ

Private Citizens for Census Duty: Legal Powers and Limits

The Centre amended the Census Rules, 1990, to explicitly include private school teachers and employees of private establishments as eligible Census enumerators. This amendment was triggered by judicial setbacks in the Bombay and Punjab and Haryana High Courts which questioned the legal basis for requisitioning private staff.

Vajiram & Ravi: source

SOCIAL JUSTICE & WELFARE SCHEME QUICK READ

Atal Vayo Abhyuday Yojana

India's elderly population is projected to reach 23 crore by 2036, requiring a comprehensive support system for senior citizens. The government released Rs 77.98 crore as grant-in-aid to 755 projects under the Integrated Programme for Senior Citizens component of AVYAY for the quarter ending September 30, 2026. The Atal Vayo Abhyuday Yojana seeks to address this demographic shift by strengthening institutional mechanisms and promoting community-based support for older persons.

PIB: source

HISTORY, ART & CULTURE AGREEMENT/MOU QUICK READ

Ministry of Culture signs MoU with Bibliothèque nationale de France to strengthen preservation of India’s manuscript heritage

A Memorandum of Understanding was signed on 26 October 2026 in Paris between the Ministry of Culture and the Bibliothèque nationale de France. The agreement aims to strengthen institutional cooperation in the preservation, digitisation, research, and dissemination of manuscript and documentary heritage. The partnership was signed under the Gyan Bharatam Mission by Shri Vivek Aggarwal, Secretary, Ministry of Culture, and Mr Gilles Pécout, President of BnF.

PIB: source

INTERNATIONAL RELATIONS AGREEMENT/MOU QUICK READ

Turkish parliamentary committee approves defence pact with Saudi Arabia, Pakistan

A Turkish parliamentary foreign affairs committee approved a trilateral defence agreement with Saudi Arabia and Pakistan on Tuesday. The approval comes amid growing tensions between Riyadh and Iran-backed Houthi rebels in the region. The core provision mandates that an armed attack on any of the three member nations will be treated as an attack on all three.

Economic Times: source

GOVERNANCE & POLICY | REPORT/INDEX | QUICK READ

NHRC, India issues an Advisory on 'Women's Safety at Work and Public Spaces'

The National Human Rights Commission has issued an advisory on women's safety at work and public spaces to various authorities. The advisory was sent to the secretaries of ten Union ministries, the Railway Board chairperson, and all state and union territory chief secretaries or administrators. The commission noted that women's safety remains a concern despite existing stringent laws protecting their rights.

PIB: source

INTERNATIONAL RELATIONS | QUICK READ

BRICS Forum adopts joint declaration; condemns Pahalgam attack, seeks UNSC reforms

The two-day conclave of the BRICS Parliamentary Forum adopted a joint declaration strongly condemning the 2025 Pahalgam attack. The declaration was announced by Lok Sabha Speaker Om Birla and pledged to combat terrorism in all its forms and manifestations. It also condemned the imposition of unilateral economic and secondary sanctions due to their negative implications on human rights.

The Hindu: source

DEFENCE | EXERCISE | QUICK READ

Exercise GARUDA SHAKTI 2026

The 11th edition of the India-Indonesia Joint Special Forces Exercise Garuda Shakti commenced at Banyuwangi, Indonesia. The bilateral exercise is conducted alternately between the Indian Army and the Indonesian National Armed Forces to advance tactical synergy and operational capabilities. The core objective is to strengthen bilateral defence cooperation, improve military interoperability, and exchange counter-insurgency and counter-terrorism expertise.

Insights on India: source

HEALTH | QUICK READ

India firmly committed to clean sport: Dr. Mansukh Mandaviya at COP10 Bureau meeting under UNESCO International Convention against Doping in Sport

Union Sports Minister Dr. Mansukh Mandaviya chaired the third formal meeting of the COP10 Bureau under the UNESCO International Convention against Doping in Sport in New Delhi. The meeting advanced global anti-doping collaboration, resource mobilisation, and the Fund's Operational Strategy for 2026-2031. India highlighted its commitment to clean sport, emphasizing that athletic success must rely on talent and hard work rather than prohibited substances.

PIB: source

DEFENCE | AGREEMENT/MOU | QUICK READ

Armed forces sign MoU with Sarvam to boost AI capabilities

On 27 October 2026, Sarvam signed a five-year MoU with Headquarters Integrated Defence Staff under the Ministry of Defence. The agreement establishes an umbrella framework for artificial intelligence projects across the Indian Army, Navy, Air Force, and tri-service organisations. Sarvam will design, develop, deploy AI applications, and provide technical support for operational, training, and decision-support requirements.

Hindustan Times: source

GOVERNANCE & POLICY | SCHEME | QUICK READ

PM Vishwakarma Artisans Showcase India's Traditional Crafts at BRICS Cultural Bazar

Eight artisans and craftspeople under the PM Vishwakarma Scheme participated in the Cultural Bazar during the 12th BRICS Parliamentary Forum. The event was organized at the Parliament House Complex in New Delhi on October 26-27 under the Ministry of MSME. The Cultural Bazar showcased India's rich cultural heritage, traditional crafts, and indigenous skills to national and international delegates.

PIB: source

DEFENCE | AGREEMENT/MOU | QUICK READ

Badr Memorandum of Understanding (MoU)

Turkey, Pakistan, Qatar, and Indonesia signed the Badr Memorandum of Understanding on October 21 to deepen defence cooperation and strengthen military capabilities. The agreement aims to promote modern defence industries, integrated supply chains, joint production facilities, and technical defence training. The term Badr means full moon, symbolizing the complementary capabilities of the four participating nations.

ForumIAS: source

SOCIAL JUSTICE & WELFARE | SCHEME | QUICK READ

Under NAMASTE Scheme, Union Minister of State Shri B. L. Verma Distributes PPE Kits And Ayushman Cards To Safai Mitras In Moradabad, Uttar Pradesh

Union Minister of State for Social Justice and Empowerment B.L. Verma distributed PPE kits and Ayushman cards to sanitation workers in Moradabad, Uttar Pradesh. The programme was organised at the Peeli Kothi Civil Lines area to promote the safety, health, dignity, and social security of sanitation workers. The initiative forms part of the central government's National Action for Mechanised Sanitation Ecosystem (NAMASTE) scheme.

PIB: source

GOVERNANCE & POLICY | PLACE IN NEWS | QUICK READ

Government of India Introduces Concessional Local Pass for National Highway Users Living Near Fee Plazas

The Government of India has introduced a Concessional Local Pass for non-commercial vehicle owners residing within 20 km of a national highway fee plaza. The new provision aims to ease daily commuting costs and enhance the Ease of Living for residents living near toll plazas. The scheme comes into effect from November 1, 2026, offering an annual pass option instead of the existing monthly pass.

PIB: source

ENVIRONMENT & ECOLOGY | SPECIES | PLACE IN NEWS | QUICK READ

Ranthambore Tiger Reserve

Tigress T-2403 was recently spotted with three cubs in the Ranthambore Tiger Reserve, located in Rajasthan. Forest officials stated that the exact number of cubs seen with the tigress is yet to be officially confirmed. Ranthambore Tiger Reserve is situated in the Sawai Madhopur district and spans approximately 1,334 square kilometres.

ForumIAS: source

INTERNATIONAL RELATIONS | REPORT/INDEX | QUICK READ

In a first since 2023, Delhi invites Pakistan Minister for inaugural SCO Civilisational Dialogue in November

India has invited Pakistan’s Minister for National Heritage and Culture, Aurangzeb Khan Khichi, to attend the first Shanghai Cooperation Organisation Civilisational Dialogue Forum. The forum is scheduled to take place in New Delhi from November 20 to 22 and will be inaugurated by Prime Minister Narendra Modi.

The Hindu: source

ENVIRONMENT & ECOLOGY | REPORT/INDEX | QUICK READ

El Nino ramping up into a ‘very strong' weather event as index surges to 18-year high

The Australian Meteorological body reported on October 25 that the Nino3.4 index reached its highest level since 2008. The Nino3.4 index surged to an 18-year high as El Nino ramps up into a very strong weather event alongside a positive Indian Ocean Dipole. Nino3.4 index highest since 2008 as of October 25, while a positive Indian Ocean Dipole event is underway, says Australian Met body

BusinessLine: source

DEFENCE | EXERCISE | QUICK READ

CONCLUSION OF 33rd EDITION OF SINGAPORE-INDIA MARITIME BILATERAL EXERCISE (SIMBEX-2026)

The 33rd edition of the Singapore-India Maritime Bilateral Exercise (SIMBEX-2026) concluded on October 26, 2026. The exercise was hosted by the Indian Navy at Visakhapatnam to strengthen longstanding maritime cooperation and operational engagement. Col Bertram Ang, Fleet Commander of the Republic of Singapore Navy, met RAdm Vishal Bishnoi to discuss mutual maritime interests.

PIB: source

HISTORY, ART & CULTURE | REPORT/INDEX | QUICK READ

IGNCA and ASI to Launch Timeless India: Protection & Revival of Indian Cultural Identity

The Archaeological Survey of India and the Indira Gandhi National Centre for the Arts are organizing the book launch. The book is titled Timeless India: Protection & Revival of Indian Cultural Identity under the Leadership of Prime Minister Narendra Modi. The event is scheduled for Wednesday, 28 October 2026, at Dharohar Bhawan in Mandi House, New Delhi.

PIB: source

GOVERNANCE & POLICY | QUICK READ

U.P. approves robotics park and AI hub in Greater Noida

The Uttar Pradesh Cabinet approved plans to establish a robotics and artificial intelligence park spanning 69.52 acres in Greater Noida. The project aims to promote domestic robotics manufacturing, speed up AI technology development, and attract investment and research activity. The Cabinet also cleared four link expressway projects spanning about 322 km at an estimated combined cost of Rs. 17,542.06 crore.

The Hindu: source

SCIENCE & TECHNOLOGY | AGREEMENT/MOU | QUICK READ

NPCI inks MoU with IIIT Hyderabad to boost digital payments security

IIIT Hyderabad and the National Payments Corporation of India signed an MoU to enhance cybersecurity across India's digital payments ecosystem. The collaboration focuses on joint research, innovation, and capacity building to address emerging risks in digital transactions. The partnership combines NPCI's experience in national payment systems with IIIT Hyderabad's advanced technology research capabilities.

timesofindia.indiatimes.com: source

GOVERNANCE & POLICY | JUDGMENT | QUICK READ

Supreme Court Reserves Verdict On PIL To Cap Drug Prices After Slamming 1,000% Cancer Drug Mark-Up

The Supreme Court reserved its judgment on a public interest litigation seeking tighter regulation of medicine prices. The court questioned why a uniform trade margin cap of 16% cannot be imposed across all drugs. The bench sharply criticized private hospitals for charging steep mark-ups, calling the practice dacoity. Private hospitals argued that higher margins help offset losses from government health schemes and insurance reimbursements.

cnbctv18.com: source

AGRICULTURE & ALLIED | QUICK READ

Maharashtra Government Approves Rs. 7,500 Crore for Drought Relief

The Maharashtra cabinet approved a Rs 7,500 crore provision to provide advance financial assistance of Rs 5,000 each to eligible farmers ahead of Diwali. The decision aims to provide immediate financial support to farmers in drought-hit regions while crop damage assessments continue. The core issue involves mitigating agrarian distress and crop failure caused by drought conditions across multiple talukas in the state.

newindianexpress.com: source

INTERNATIONAL RELATIONS | AGREEMENT/MOU | QUICK READ

India-Chile FTA talks 'quite ripe' for conclusion, Canada negotiations making progress: Goyal

Commerce and Industry Minister Piyush Goyal stated that India's free trade agreement talks with Chile are quite ripe for conclusion. Negotiations with Canada are also making very good progress as part of India's broader outreach to forge trade pacts. Talks have started with the South Africa-led Southern African Customs Union after both sides inked terms of reference in August.

BusinessLine: source

GOVERNANCE & POLICY | ACT/BILL/RULES | QUICK READ

Viksit Bharat–G RAM G Act, 2025

The Viksit Bharat–Guarantee for Rozgar and Ajeevika Mission (Gramin) (VB-G RAM G) generated 31.69 crore person-days of employment as of 24th September 2026. The scheme stems from the VB-G RAM G Act, 2025, which officially replaced MGNREGA on 1st July 2026 to strengthen rural livelihoods. The core issue centers on balancing guaranteed wage employment with sustainable rural asset creation and decentralized grassroots planning.

drishtiias.com: source

HISTORY, ART & CULTURE | REPORT/INDEX | QUICK READ

UNESCO Team Reviews Hampi Heritage Sites, Report Expected in Six Weeks

A team of UNESCO and ICOMOS experts inspected historical monuments and heritage sites in Vijayanagara district to review conservation and tourism. The inspection was triggered by the need to assess current preservation measures, commercial construction, and tourist management around Hampi. The core issue focuses on balancing heritage conservation with local livelihoods and preventing commercial construction from obstructing historical views.

deccanchronicle.com: source

INFRASTRUCTURE & ENERGY | QUICK READ

Cabinet approves four railway multitracking projects worth Rs 9,450 crore

The Cabinet Committee on Economic Affairs approved four railway multitracking projects of the Ministry of Railways costing Rs 9,450 crore. The projects span 410 km across eight districts in West Bengal, Odisha, Tamil Nadu and Andhra Pradesh. The approved projects include the Kharagpur-Bhadrak fourth line, Bhadrak-Haridaspur fourth line, Gummidipundi-Gudur third and fourth lines, and Cuttack-Paradeep third and fourth lines.

ddnews.gov.in: source

EDITORIAL WATCH

What the opinion pages argued: two or three lines each.

GS3 UPSC Editorial Analysis: Inflation and Early Distress Control in India

Consumer Price Index inflation in India frequently tests the Reserve Bank of India's upper tolerance threshold of 6%, driven mainly by volatile food components. The author argues that interventions usually arrive late after food shocks have depleted household savings and triggered broader price pressures. Food inflation is regressive, forcing lower-income deciles who spend 45% to 60% of their expenditure on food to suffer a severe loss in real purchasing power.

Insights on India

GS2 Why inclusion is key to the RTE Act

The piece is published as an opinion commentary in The Hindu focusing on educational development and the RTE Act. The editorial discusses the critical need for metrics to track inclusion under the Right to Education (RTE) Act, arguing that unmeasured inclusion remains undervalued. An essential tenet of educational development is that what gets measured gets valued. Inclusion remains deeply undervalued because India lacks the metrics to track it

The Hindu

GS2 As the Maldives diversifies its foreign policy, India should make red lines clear

Maldivian President Muizzu is pursuing strong relations with Sunni Muslim nations and diversifying ties beyond India, risking India's long-term security. Geography and religion shape Maldives-Pakistan relations, and engagements have increased under Muizzu to boost his nationalist credentials and foreign policy diversification. The Maldives has signed defence MoUs with China, Turkiye, and Pakistan, procured UAVs and armoured vehicles, and joined a Saudi Arabia-led maritime defence coalition.

msn.com

GS3 Editorial. El Nino woes

It is in the news due to concerns over the adverse impact of deficient monsoon rainfall on the economy. The editorial discusses the macroeconomic fallout of a poor monsoon driven by El Nino and calls for a robust policy response to tackle rural distress and inflation. Fallout of poor monsoon calls for macro policy response

BusinessLine

GS3 India needs a jobs toolkit to arm its youth for the AI-infused economy

The evolving impact of artificial intelligence on employment trends and the need for policy intervention have put skill development in the news. The editorial argues that India requires a comprehensive jobs toolkit to prepare its youth for an AI-infused economy as technology raises entry-level job barriers. As technology raises the bar for entry-level jobs, policy must change gears to equip the next generation of workers with skills necessary to adapt in an artificial intelligence-led world.

Mint

GS3 India's Next Investment Cycle Will Shape Its Carbon Future

The UNEP warning on rising global temperatures highlights the need for India to align its upcoming investment cycle with decarbonisation goals. NITI Aayog estimates that 86% of India's building stock for 2070 is yet to be built, with floor space expanding from 18 to 42 billion square metres. Crude-steel capacity is targeted to reach 300 million tonnes by 2030-31 and cement output is projected to rise to 660 million tonnes by 2030.

The Hindu

GS3 UPSC Editorial Analysis: Rethinking India's Large Dams

India ranks third globally with over 5700 registered large dams, historically viewed as essential engines of post-independence growth. Changing climate patterns, extreme precipitation, structural ageing, and heavy siltation have turned many reservoirs from flood buffers into flood accelerants. Large dams support agricultural resilience, clean energy integration, urban water security, and drought mitigation. Over 80 percent of Indian large dams are more than 25 years old, with over 230 exceeding 100 years of service, posing structural risks.

Insights on India

GS3 Climate justice needs quicker compensation

The UN climate convention's Fund for Loss and Damage allocated $21.6 million to Nepal following devastating floods, marking the Fund's first grant to a disaster-affected nation. Nepal invoked climate justice, noting it accounts for barely 0.1 percent of global emissions yet faces severe climate impacts in the Himalayas. The disaster involved an ice-and-rock avalanche triggering flash floods in the Bhotekoshi and Trishuli river systems, claiming over 1,400 lives and causing massive infrastructural losses.

msn.com

GS3 The AI boom may transform the economy and still destroy capital, with stranded data centres and heavy investor losses

US hyperscalers like Amazon, Google, and Microsoft are pouring massive sums into AI, with capital expenditure expected to reach $800 billion in 2026. Economist Paul Krugman argued that heavy AI investments are crowding out other potential uses of capital in the economy. Data shows US gross domestic investment as a share of GDP has barely changed, edging up from 21.3 percent pre-Covid to 21.5 percent since 2022.

Economic Times

GS3 Fast money is leaving, patient money is arriving—and RBI quietly rewrites the rules

In early October, the Indian rupee fell to about Rs 96.7 to the dollar amid declining foreign exchange reserves, foreign equity divestments, and high oil prices. The Reserve Bank of India implemented strategic measures targeting rapid capital movement to stabilise the rupee while maintaining independent interest rate policies. The RBI reduced currency derivative transaction limits without underlying trade from $100 million to $5 million and banned speculative hedge rebookings.

ThePrint

GS1 GS2 Elder care demands a policy push

The Keralam Assembly passed the Senior Citizens (Care and Protection of Rights) Bill, 2026, to improve elder care and create an institutional framework. Rapid demographic transitions, higher life expectancy, and outward migration of youth make comprehensive elder care policies imperative for the state. By 2036, an estimated 22% of Keralam's population will be aged 60 and above, reflecting an impending national demographic trend. The bill mandates registration for care centres and caregivers while establishing prescribed standards, penalties, and legal support for ageing in place.

Deccan Herald

GS3 Service capacity is the solar industry's next infrastructure gap

India reached 171.05 GW of installed solar capacity by the end of September 2026, with ground-mounted projects contributing nearly 126 GW. The rapid expansion of solar capacity means the industry must shift focus from building at speed to operating the fleet reliably over decades. Unplanned plant downtime causes heavy financial losses, such as a 100 MW plant losing Rs. 13 lakh daily when sitting idle at a 22% capacity factor.

Hindustan Times

GS3 India's steel ambitions: Why they need a clear climate transition plan

It is in the news due to discussions surrounding India's steel policy goals and the urgent need to balance industrial growth with climate action. The editorial highlights the necessity of establishing clear, achievable milestones for India's steel sector to ensure cleaner output by 2047. Achievable milestones are needed to make the steel policy's 2047 goal for cleaner output meaningful.

Mint

GS3 Grant researchers funds and be patient with results

The article discusses how long-term grants for scientific research need patient funding, proper exit plans, and immunity from annual budgetary interruptions. Data from the US Howard Hughes Medical Institute shows long-term funded scientists produce double the top 1% citation papers while tackling harder problems. External expert panels reviewing researchers' five best papers ensure accountability, with roughly one in six to one in four losing funding at review stages.

Hindustan Times

GS3 AI kids need adult eyes in the lab

Leaders like Satya Nadella and Sam Altman raised concerns over advanced artificial intelligence safety and the need for global governance. Tech leaders Satya Nadella and Sam Altman have called for a reassessment of AI safety frameworks to address existential threats through global governance and voluntary restraint. Advanced artificial intelligence presents significant existential threats that necessitate immediate global governance. Investors are encouraged to proceed with caution, while tech creators are urged to voluntarily practice restraint for public safety.

Economic Times

EXPLAINED

The concept behind the news, one or two lines each.

Climate Justice and India's Energy Transition The debate on global climate policy highlights India's need to prioritise energy justice, equitable energy consumption, and nationally driven climate action alongside global emissions targets. Climate justice links climate action with fairness, development, and the unequal distribution of responsibilities and resources across countries.

Vajiram & Ravi

Form 6, voter roll deletions: What Election Commission told the Supreme Court The Election Commission made these submissions in response to proceedings before the Supreme Court concerning voter list management. The Election Commission of India submitted clarifications to the Supreme Court regarding procedures governing Form 6 applications and the deletion of names from voter rolls.

Indian Express

Explainer: Why News Publishers Challenged Data Protection Law In Supreme Court The Supreme Court sought the Centre's response on a petition by the Digital News Publishers Association challenging the DPDP Act and Rules. The association argues that the law lacks any exemption for journalism, which could cripple news gathering and dilute the right to information.

NDTV

El Nino: Concept & Impacts The World Meteorological Organization warned that the 2026 El Niño could be unprecedented in intensity, potentially becoming one of the strongest events since 1950 and persisting into 2027. El Niño is driven by unusual warming of surface waters in the central and eastern tropical Pacific Ocean, marking the warm phase of the ENSO cycle.

ForumIAS

Explained | Cyclone Arnab: Who named this storm and what does it mean? A deep depression over the Bay of Bengal intensified into Cyclone Arnab and is expected to become a very severe cyclonic storm. The storm is forecast to cross the Andhra Pradesh and Yanam coasts near Yanam between Bapatla and Visakhapatnam by October 28 forenoon.

deccanherald.com

What the new E100 vehicle rules mean Recent amendments to Rule 115 and Rule 115E have been notified to establish emission testing frameworks for high-ethanol-blend vehicles. The new rules amend provisions under the Central Motor Vehicles Rules to regulate emission standards and testing for vehicles running on high blends of ethanol up to E100.
The Hindu

Black October: An expert explains how AI is changing cybersecurity The explainer was published in response to emerging trends in cyber threats often referred to as Black October. An expert analysis explains how artificial intelligence is reshaping the domain of cybersecurity and altering threat dynamics.
Indian Express

Expert Explains | To counter China along LAC, why its grey-zone warfare tactics must be understood The strategic need to decode non-conventional border aggression has brought grey-zone warfare into contemporary policy discussions. An explainer on why India must understand China's grey-zone warfare tactics to effectively counter security challenges along the Line of Actual Control.
Indian Express

From Israeli missiles to the Strait of Hormuz: 5 reasons why Netanyahu's election fate matters to India... The article is in the news due to upcoming Israeli elections and their potential fallout on bilateral ties and regional stability. This explainer outlines five key reasons why the political survival and election fate of Israeli Prime Minister Benjamin Netanyahu matters significantly to India's strategic, defence, and economic interests.
Moneycontrol.com

Can Netanyahu Win Again Despite Iran War? 5 Scenarios Ahead Of Israel's October 27 Elections The explainer comes ahead of Israel's scheduled general elections on October 27, 2026. An analysis of the potential political scenarios and factors determining whether Prime Minister Benjamin Netanyahu can win the upcoming Israeli elections amidst ongoing conflicts.
News18

Knowledge Nugget | How is Indian Railways rethinking safety and security? The strategic review of safety protocols is in the news due to concerted efforts to modernize rail infrastructure and eliminate accidents. Indian Railways is rethinking its safety and security architecture by adopting advanced indigenous technologies, better signaling, and upgraded infrastructure.
Indian Express

What China's latest missile footage tells us about its military preparedness Chinese state broadcaster CCTV released a brief video showing troops conducting a rocket launch exercise in mountainous terrain without advance notice to the troops. The drill aimed to test how effectively troops can respond and execute a launch when given little time to prepare.
theprint.in

ALSO IN THE NEWS

Reactions, previews and smaller stories: one line each.

- Union Minister for Education, Shri Pralhad Joshi, to felicitate winners of Viksit Bharat Buildathon 2025 on Oct 28, 2026 (Education) PIB
- Phuket Island (Geography) Vajiram & Ravi
- SC says 'will examine' petitioners' 'innocuous' plea to direct ECI to preserve or file in court 'complete' SIR records (Polity & Constitution) The Hindu
- Expenditure quality key to states' long-term fiscal health: RBI Governor (Economy) Business Standard
- Chip war exposes India's semiconductor vulnerabilities, industry leaders say (Science & Technology) The Hindu
- India must make its defence chips end-to-end, say scientists (Science & Technology) The Hindu
- Government mulls simplifying application process under Press Note 2 to ease FDI flow from border nations: Sources (Economy) Economic Times
- Quad 3.0: Reshaping the Indo-Pacific's Regional Architecture (International Relations) India's World
- Gujarat, Rajasthan declare drought in 18 districts as rainfall deficit hits farmers (Disaster Management) Down To Earth
- Supreme Court Issues Notice To Centre On Pleas Challenging Mandate To Sing Six-Stanza Version Of Vande... (Polity & Constitution) LiveLaw
- India's exports hit record $863.1 billion in FY26 as FTAs boost trade with UAE, UK and Australia (Economy) DD News
- Prior approval under data law could shut newsrooms: SC (Polity & Constitution) Awaz The Voice
- PM Modi, Uzbekistan President Mirziyoyev Hold Talks in Tashkent, Agree to Deepen Cooperation in Trade, Defence, Energy and Digital Connectivity (International Relations) DD News
- India evacuates tens of thousands as 'very severe' Cyclone Arnab nears (Disaster Management) Al Jazeera
- Kuno cheetah cub likely shot, pellets found in first such cheetah killing in India (Environment & Ecology) Indian Express
- "Political accountability becomes ethically questionable when the pursuit of justice is indistinguishable from the pursuit of political advantage." Comment. (Ethics & Integrity) Insights on India
- Parliamentary panel recommends to increase retirement age of judges in High Courts, Supreme Court (Polity & Constitution) ETLegalWorld.com
- 'Govt allowing this to happen': Supreme Court questions on overpricing of medicines, massive gap in MRP and cost to retailers (Governance & Policy) Hindustan Times

- India considers measures to boost local production of 100 critical inputs to cut import reliance, government official says (Economy) Economic Times
- India's Extreme Poverty at 2%, but 1.14 Billion Remain Below a Higher Poverty Line: World Bank (Economy) The Policy Edge
- CEC powers: 10 key objections and the ECI's responses (Polity & Constitution) Supreme Court Observer
- 'Win-Win For All': Piyush Goyal Said On India-EU Free Trade Deal (International Relations) NDTV
- SC issues notice as legacy media warns of 'pre-censorship' via Modi govt's data law (Polity & Constitution) Newslaundry
- Life sentences for multiple offences in single trial cannot run consecutively: Supreme Court (Polity & Constitution) Deccan Herald
- Greenhouse gases hit record highs in 2025, locking in further global warming, warns WMO (Environment & Ecology) The Economic Times
- Prime Minister Shri Narendra Modi inaugurates Emerging Science, Technology and Innovation Conclave 2026 (Science & Technology) PIB
- China's $168 Billion Brahmaputra Dam and Flood Risks (International Relations) GKToday
- Industrial credit growth nears 20%, signals private capex revival; Shaktikanta Das urges banks to fund strategic sectors (Economy) Mint
- Shram Samvad - Two-Day State-Level Capacity-Building and Awareness Programme on Labour Codes, Labour Welfare and Social Protection Concludes in Lucknow (Governance & Policy) PIB
- India needs $500 bn by 2030 to decarbonise key sectors: CEEW report (Environment & Ecology) Business Standard
- SC restores Karnataka land, says government can acquire only for public purpose (Polity & Constitution) Times of India
- 'Don't panic over rupee fall': Raghuram Rajan warns against exhausting forex reserves (Economy) Mint
- 6 years jail, Rs. 6 lakh aid: Supreme Court tells Uttar Pradesh to pay for 'poor probe' after man acquitted in murder case (Polity & Constitution) Hindustan Times
- After spending Rs. 12,000 crore, only 21 out of 130 cities meet clean air target (Environment & Ecology) Hindustan Times
- Regional Rural Workshop under PMAY-G Held in Lucknow to Review Progress and Deliberate on Reforms for the Next Phase (Governance & Policy) PIB
- Isro to launch NVS-03 soon: Why it's a major boost for India's own GPS (Science & Technology) India Today
- A cooling-off period for MPs, MLAs who quit? SC to decide (Polity & Constitution) Times of India
- Rock Cut Architecture, Types, Examples, Ajanta Caves, Evolution (History, Art & Culture) Vajiram & Ravi
- India's crude basket price tops $120 a barrel amid West Asia war (Economy) BusinessLine
- Statutory Restrictions Can't Curtail Article 226 Powers To Order FIR, Investigation Where Cognizable... (Polity & Constitution) Live Law
- Minority judge blocked, Dhana's tactics, government's pre-approval: Justice SK Kaul reveals inner workings of Collegium (Polity & Constitution) Bar & Bench
- NVS-03 Mission Strengthening India's Indigenous Navigation System (Science & Technology) Hindustan Times
- Battery Energy Storage Systems in India: Benefits and Challenges (Infrastructure & Energy) NEXT IAS
- India urges science-based safeguards for synthetic biology at COP17 (Environment & Ecology) The Climate Watch

COVERAGE CHECK

Items — 16 must-know, 26 Prelims facts, 44 in the news, 15 editorials, 12 explainers.

Syllabus areas in the cards — Economy (8), Governance & Policy (6), Environment & Ecology (5), International Relations (5), Defence (5), Polity & Constitution (4), History, Art & Culture (3), Social Justice & Welfare (2), Health (1), Science & Technology (1), Agriculture & Allied (1), Infrastructure & Energy (1). **Nothing today in —** Education, Internal Security, Disaster Management, Geography, Society, Ethics & Integrity.

Easy-miss watch — Marine & coastal (EEZ, UNCLOS, Blue Economy, deep sea): 4 · Digital Public Infrastructure & data governance: 3 · Political change in the neighbourhood: 3 · Appointments to constitutional / statutory / regulatory bodies: 1 · Defence-technology cooperation agreements: 1

Full text — 53 of 69 items were read in full from a free copy; the rest are summarised from the outlets' reports. Subscriber-only sites are never opened.

Sources in the cards — PIB 11, The Hindu 7, Economic Times 7, Hindustan Times 6, ddnews.gov.in 4, Indian Express 4, Insights on India 3, ForumIAS 3, BusinessLine 3, Vajiram & Ravi 2, msn.com 2, Mint 2, RBI 1, lokmattimes.com 1

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